

Sheaf Theory

Labix

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Abstract

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1 The General Theory of Sheaves

1.1 Basic Definition of Presheaves

As with how we equipped to each variety V its coordinate ring $k[V]$ which are functions on V , we want to equip to each spectrum some ring which are functions on them. It will not make sense that we can define functions on spectrums immediately.

In its full generality, sheaves are designed to encode all local information into one compact notation. It often has uses in complex geometry for its differential forms and smooth functions. In algebraic geometry it is fundamental for redefining the notion of a variety.

Definition 1.1.1 (The Category of Open Sets) Let $(X, \mathcal{T})$ be a topological space. Define the category $\mathbf{Open}(X)$ to consist of the following data.

- The objects $\mathbf{Ob}(\mathbf{Open}(X)) = \mathcal{T}$ are the open sets of X
- For $U, V \subseteq X$ two open sets of X , the morphisms

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbf{Open}(X)}(U, V) = \begin{cases} \{\iota : U \hookrightarrow V \text{ the inclusion map}\} & \text{if } U \subseteq V \\ \emptyset & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

- Composition is given as the composition of functions.

Recall from Category Theory 1 that a presheaf on $\mathcal{C}$ is just a contravariant functor $\mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$. Using the category of open sets we can now define presheaves on spaces.

Definition 1.1.2 (Presheaves on a Space)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X is a contravariant functor

$$\mathcal{F} : \mathbf{Open}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

As per the definition of a functor, for each inclusion map $\iota : V \rightarrow U$ of open sets in X , passing through a presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ gives a unique morphism $\mathcal{F}(\iota) : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(V)$. We often denote $\mathcal{F}(\iota)$ as res_V^U or $(-)|_V$.

Example 1.1.3 (The Constant Presheaf)

Let X be a space. Let S be a set. Define the constant presheaf with value S to be the presheaf $\underline{S}_{\mathrm{pre}}$ defined as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, we have

$$\underline{S}_{\mathrm{pre}}(U) = S$$

- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$ of open sets, define

$$\mathrm{res}_V^U = \mathrm{id}_S$$

Definition 1.1.4 (The Stalk of a Presheaf) Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf on a topological space $(X, \mathcal{T})$. Let $p \in X$. Consider the full subcategory $\mathcal{J}_p$ of $\mathbf{Open}(X)$ consisting of open sets in X that contain p . Define the stalk of $\mathcal{F}$ at p to be the colimit

$$\mathcal{F}_p = \mathrm{colim}_{\mathcal{J}_p} \mathcal{F}(V_p)$$

Definition 1.1.5 (Morphism of Presheaves)

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaves on X . A morphism $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a natural transformation of functors.

Notice that the natural transformation ϕ here takes every open set U and maps it to a group homomorphism $\phi(U) : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$ if $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ are presheaves with values in $\mathbf{Grp}$.

Definition 1.1.6 (Induced Map of Stalks)

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaves on X . Let $p \in X$. Define the induced map of stalks

$$\phi_p : \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$$

to be the map induced by the universal product of colimits.

Definition 1.1.7 (Isomorphism of Presheaves)

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of presheaves. We say that φ is an isomorphism if φ is a natural isomorphism. In this case, we say that $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ are isomorphic.

1.2 Sheaves with Values in a Set

Definition 1.2.1 (Sheaves) Let X be a space. A Set-sheaf on X is a Set-presheaf $\mathcal{F} : \mathbf{Open} \rightarrow \mathbf{Sets}$ satisfying two additional properties

- Identity: If $\{U_i | i \in I\}$ is an open cover of U and $\phi_1, \phi_2 \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ and $\phi_1|_{U_i} = \phi_2|_{U_i}$ for all i , then $\phi_1 = \phi_2$
- Gluing: If $\{U_i | i \in I\}$ is an open cover of U and $\phi_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ for all $i \in I$ such that $\phi_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = \phi_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all $i, j \in I$, then there exists some $\phi \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $\phi|_{U_i} = \phi_i$ for all $i \in I$.

Example 1.2.2

Let X, Y be spaces. Define a presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on X by

$$\mathcal{F}(U) = \{f : U \rightarrow Y \mid f \text{ is continuous}\}$$

for $U \subseteq X$ an open set, together with restriction maps. Then $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

Proof

Identity: Suppose that $f, g \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ for some open set $U \subseteq X$ and $f|_{U_i} = g|_{U_i}$ for $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ an open cover of U . Then for any $x \in U$, there exists $i \in I$ such that $x \in U_i$, and so

$$f(x) = f|_{U_i}(x) = g|_{U_i}(x) = g(x)$$

Hence $f = g$.

Gluing: Suppose that $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ for $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ an open cover of an open set $U \subseteq X$ such that $f_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = f_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$. Define $f \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ by $f(x) = f_i(x)$ for $x \in U_i$. This is well defined since $\{f_i\}$ agree on intersections. It remains to show that f is continuous. Let $W \subseteq Y$ be an open set. I claim that $f^{-1}(W) = \bigcup_{i \in I} f_i^{-1}(W)$. Let $x \in f^{-1}(W)$. Then $f(x) \in W$. Since $x \in W \subseteq U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$, there exists $i \in I$ such that $x \in U_i$. Hence $f_i(x) = f(x) \in W$. Thus $x \in f_i^{-1}(W)$. Conversely, suppose that $x \in f_i^{-1}(W)$. Then clearly $f(x) = f_i(x) \in W$ so that $x \in f^{-1}(W)$. Thus $f^{-1}(W) = \bigcup_{i \in I} f_i^{-1}(W)$. Since each f_i is continuous and W is an open set, $f_i^{-1}(W)$ is open and so the arbitrary union of $f_i^{-1}(W)$ is open. Hence $f^{-1}(W)$ is open. ■

Example 1.2.3 (Locally Constant Sheaf)

Let X be a space. Let S be a set. Define the locally constant presheaf $\underline{S}$ of X with values in S as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define

$$\underline{S}(U) = \{f : U \rightarrow S \mid f \text{ is continuous where } S \text{ has the discrete topology}\}$$

- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$ of open subsets, define the induced map $\underline{S}(U) \rightarrow \underline{S}(V)$ by $f \mapsto f|_V$.

The following are true regarding the locally constant sheaf.

- $\underline{S}$ is a sheaf.

- Let $U \subseteq X$ be an open set. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be the set of connected components of U . Then

$$\underline{S}(U) \cong \prod_{C \in \mathcal{B}} S$$

- For all $p \in X$, $\underline{S}_p = S$.

Proof

Let Y be a connected component of U . Let $f \in \underline{S}(Y)$. I claim that f is constant. Let $y_0 \in Y$. Define $A = \{y \in Y \mid f(y) = f(y_0)\} = f^{-1}(f(y_0))$ and $B = \{y \in Y \mid f(y) \neq f(y_0)\}$. Clearly $Y = A \cup B$ and $A \cap B = \emptyset$. Both A and B are open sets since S has a discrete topology. Since Y is connected and A is non-empty, this implies that $B = \emptyset$. Hence $Y = A$ and f is constant on Y . Thus there is a bijection $\underline{S}(Y) \cong S$.

Define a function $\underline{S}(U) \rightarrow \prod_{C \in \mathcal{B}} S$ as follows. For each connected component $C \in \mathcal{B}$ of U , choose $x_C \in C$. Then the map is defined by $f \mapsto (f(x_C))$. This map is injective since $f(x_C) = g(x_C)$ implies that $f(C) = g(C)$ for all connected components $C \in \mathcal{B}$. Hence $f = g$. It is surjective since for any choice of sequence $(x_C)_{C \in \mathcal{B}}$, the map $f : U \rightarrow S$ defined by $f(x) = x_C$ for $x \in C$ is continuous because S is discrete and $\{x_C\}$ is a closed set, and $f^{-1}(x_C) = C$ is a connected component and so is a closed set. ■

Proposition 1.2.4 (Gluing Sheaves)

Let X be a space. Let $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ be an open cover of X . Let $\mathcal{F}_i$ be a sheaf of sets on U_i . Let $\phi_{i,j} : \mathcal{F}_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ be a collection of morphism of sheaves for ranging $i, j \in I$ such that the following are true.

- For each $i, j \in I$, $\phi_{i,j}$ is an isomorphism.
- For each $i, j, k \in I$, we have $\phi_{j,k} \circ \phi_{i,j} = \phi_{i,k}$.

Then there exists a unique (up to unique isomorphism) sheaf of sets $\mathcal{F}$ on X such that there are isomorphisms $\mathcal{F}|_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{F}_i$ for all $i \in I$.

1.3 Sheaves with Values in a Category

Presheaves are easily generalized to take values in an arbitrary category because they are simply defined to be contravariant functors.

Definition 1.3.1 (Presheaves with Values in a Category) Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A presheaf on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$ is a contravariant functor

$$\mathcal{F} : \mathbf{Open}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

However, it is hard to define sheaves with values on an arbitrary category $\mathcal{C}$. This is because in our definition of sheaves on sets, we made use of the fact that morphisms in $\mathbf{Set}$ have a well defined notion of restriction. We will define sheaves on a general category by first considering sheaves with an underlying set.

Theorem 1.3.2 Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf with values in $\mathbf{Set}$. Then the following are equivalent characterizations.

- $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf
- For any open covering $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{f} \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightarrow{g} \prod_{i,j \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

where f is given by the product of the unique maps $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ and g is given by sending $(s_i)_{i \in I}$ to $(s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} - s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j \in I}$ is exact.

- For any open covering $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$, the following diagram

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{f} \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightleftharpoons[h]{g} \prod_{i,j \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

is an equalizer diagram, where f is given by the product of the unique maps $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U_i)$, g is given by sending $(s_i)_{i \in I}$ to $(s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j \in I}$, h is given by sending $(s_i)_{i \in I}$ to $(s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j \in I}$.

Proof

We first note that the second and third condition are equivalent. Therefore we just have to show that the first condition is equivalent to the third one. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an abelian sheaf. We want to show that $\text{im}(f) = \{x \in \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \mid g(x) = h(x)\}$. Therefore we begin with $x \in \text{im}(f)$. Then $f(x) = (x_i)_{i \in I}$. But we have that $g((x_i)_{i \in I}) = (x_i|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j \in I}$ and $h((x_i)_{i \in I}) = (x_j|_{U_i \cap U_j})_{i,j \in I}$. We want to show that for all $i, j \in I$, we have that $x_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = x_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$. But x_i is just the restriction of x to U_i and x_j is the restriction of x to U_j . But by definition of a sheaf, restricting to V_i and further to V_{ij} is the same as directly restricting to V_{ij} . Similarly, restricting to V_j and further to V_{ij} is the same as directly restricting to V_{ij} . We conclude that applying g and h to $(x_i)_{i \in I}$ give the same element. Thus $x \in \{x \in \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \mid g(x) = h(x)\}$.

Now let $(y_i)_{i \in I} \in \{x \in \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \mid g(x) = h(x)\}$. This means that $y_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = y_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ for all $i, j \in I$. By the gluing axiom, there exists $y \in \mathcal{C}(U)$ such that $y|_{U_i} = y_i$. Thus y is in the image of f and we conclude that $y \in \text{im}(f)$.

Finally, we also need to show that f is injective. Suppose that $x, y \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ is such that $x_i = y_i$ for all $i \in I$. Then by the identity axiom we conclude that $x = y$. Thus f is injective. Thus the equalizer condition is satisfied.

Now suppose that the equalizer condition is satisfied. Then f is injective. This means that for $x, y \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $x_i = y_i$ for all $i \in I$, then $x = y$. But this is precisely the identity axiom. Suppose that $\text{im}(f) = \text{Eq}(g, h)$. Let $s_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that

$$s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = g(s_i) = h(s_i) = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$$

for all $i, j \in I$. Then $(s_i)_{i \in I} \in \text{Eq}(g, h) = \text{im}(f)$. Which means that there exists some $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $s|_{U_i} = s_i$. But this is the content of the gluing axiom. Since the identity and the gluing axiom are satisfied, we conclude that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. ■

Motivated by the above characterization, we define sheaves with values on a category with finite products as follows.

Definition 1.3.3 (Sheaves with Values in a Category) Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category that admits all products. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf with values in $\mathcal{C}$ if for every open covering $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$, the following diagram

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{f} \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightleftharpoons[h]{g} \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

is an equalizer diagram, where f, g, h are defined as follows.

- The morphism f is the product

$$\prod_{i \in I} \text{res}_{U_i}^U : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i)$$

- The morphism g is the product

$$\prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \text{res}_{U_i \cap U_j}^{U_i} : \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \rightarrow \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

- The morphism h is the product

$$\prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \text{res}_{U_i \cap U_j}^{U_j} : \prod_{j \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_j) \rightarrow \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

Note: the double product is ordered so that the equalizing condition is the same as the gluing condi-

tion.

Proposition 1.3.4

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category that admits all products. Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ be a functor such that the following are true.

- F is faithful.
- F preserves limits.
- A morphism $f \in \mathcal{C}$ is an isomorphism if and only if $F(f) \in \mathbf{Set}$ is an isomorphism.

Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$. Then $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf with values in $\mathcal{C}$ if and only if $F \circ \mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf of sets.

Proof

Suppose that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. Then the following diagram is an equalizer for any open set U and any open cover $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ of U :

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{f} \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightarrow[h]{g} \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

Since F commutes with limits, the following diagram is an equalizer:

$$F \circ \mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{f} \prod_{i \in I} F \circ \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightarrow[h]{g} \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} F \circ \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

Hence $F \circ \mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

Conversely, suppose that $F \circ \mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. Let E be the equalizer of the following diagram:

$$\prod_{i \in I} F \circ \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightarrow[h]{g} \prod_{(i,j) \in I \times I} F \circ \mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j)$$

By the universal property of products and the definition of a presheaf, we obtain a morphism $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow E$. Since F preserves limits, we have that $F \circ \mathcal{F}(U)$ and $F(E)$ are both equalizers of the same diagram, and so the morphism $F \circ \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow F(E)$ is an isomorphism. By assumption on F , we conclude that $\mathcal{F}(U) \cong E$. Hence $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf. ■

The following definition is inspired by the Stacks Project.

Definition 1.3.5 (Algebraic Categories)

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. We say that $\mathcal{C}$ is an algebraic category if there exists a functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ such that the following are true.

- $\mathcal{C}$ admits all products and filtered colimits.
- F is faithful (so that $\mathcal{C}$ is a concrete category).
- F preserves limits and filtered colimits.
- A morphism $f \in \mathcal{C}$ is an isomorphism if and only if $F(f) \in \mathbf{Set}$ is an isomorphism.

This allows us to simplify statements about sheaves with values in categories whose objects are algebraic in nature. Some examples of algebraic categories include:

$$\mathbf{Set}, \mathbf{Grp}, \mathbf{Ab}, \mathbf{Ring}, \mathbf{CRing}, \mathbf{Mod}_R, \mathbf{Alg}_R$$

They are all equipped with a forgetful functor to sets that is faithful, is the right adjoint of the free functor (take $\text{id} : \mathbf{Set} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ for $\mathbf{Set}$) and reflects isomorphisms.

We abuse notation and think of as if $\mathcal{F}(U)$ are sets for each open set $U \subseteq X$ (in reality only $(F \circ \mathcal{F})(U)$ are sets).

Lemma 1.3.6

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Let $p \in X$. Then we have

$$\mathcal{F}_p = \frac{\{(U, f) \mid U \subseteq X \text{ is an open neighborhood of } p, f \in \mathcal{F}(U)\}}{\sim}$$

where $(U, f) \sim (V, g)$ if there exists $W \subseteq U \cap V$ an open neighborhood of p such that $f|_W = g|_W$.

Proof If $\mathcal{F}$ is a **Set**-presheaf, the above would be an explicit construction of the filtered colimit. Since $\mathcal{C}$ is algebraic, $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ preserves colimits and by abuse of notation we obtain the following set-theoretic description. ■

Think of the definition of stalks as follows: Treat f and g to be sections in $\mathcal{F}(U_1)$ and $\mathcal{F}(U_2)$ where $V \subseteq U_1 \cap U_2$ is open and contains x . Then we think of f and g to be the same function in the stalk as long as they agree on some open set that contains x .

Indeed, since we do not care about the entirety of the domain of f and g , and only care about what happens locally near x , it makes sense for us to treat them as a function when they appear to be the same locally.

Let $[(s, U)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$ be an element of the stalk. Consider the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{F}_p & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}_p \end{array}$$

The element $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ maps vertically on the left to $[(s, U)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$. Since the diagram is commutative, we see that the image of the element in $\mathcal{F}_p$ from the induced map of stalks is $[(\phi(U)(s), U)]$. This is the formula for the induced map.

Proposition 1.3.7

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then φ is an isomorphism if and only if for all $p \in X$, the induced map

$$\varphi_p : \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof

Suppose that ϕ is an isomorphism of sheaves. Then ϕ and ϕ^{-1} induces unique morphisms $\phi_p : \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_{X,p}$ and $\phi_p^{-1} : \mathcal{G}_{X,p} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p$ making the following diagram commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\phi(U)} & \mathcal{G}(U) & \xrightarrow{\phi^{-1}(U)} & \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\phi^{-1}(U)} & \mathcal{G}(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathcal{F}_p & \xrightarrow{\exists!} & \mathcal{G}_{X,p} & \xrightarrow{\exists!} & \mathcal{F}_p & \xrightarrow{\exists!} & \mathcal{G}(V) \end{array}$$

On the other hand, the identity morphisms $\text{id}_{\mathcal{F}}$ and $\text{id}_{\mathcal{G}}$ also induces the identity map on the level of stalks. Thus we must have $\phi_p \circ \phi_p^{-1} = \text{id}_{\mathcal{G}_{X,p}}$ and $\phi_p^{-1} \circ \phi_p = \text{id}_{\mathcal{F}_p}$. Hence the induced morphism of stalks is an isomorphism.

Now suppose that ϕ_p is an isomorphism for each $p \in X$. We show that $\phi(U)$ is bijective for all $U \subseteq X$ open. Let $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $\phi(U)(s) = 0$. Then for each $p \in U$, $\phi(U)(s)$ considered as an element in $\mathcal{G}_{X,p}$ is equal to 0. Since ϕ_p is injective, $s = 0$ in $\mathcal{F}_p$. This means that there exists an open neighbourhood $V_p \subseteq U$ of p such that $s \in \phi(V_p)$ is 0 for each $p \in U$. Since U is covered by the open neighbourhoods V_p for $p \in U$, by the identity axiom we conclude that $s = 0$ in $\phi(U)$. Thus ϕ is injective.

Now let $t \in \mathcal{G}(U)$. Let t_p be the corresponding element of t in $\mathcal{G}_{X,p}$ for each $p \in U$. Since ϕ_p is surjective, there exists $s_p \in \mathcal{F}_p$ such that $\phi_p(s_p) = t_p$ for each $p \in U$. Suppose that on a neighbourhood V_p of p , s_p is represented as r_p . Then $\phi(r_p) \in \mathcal{G}(V_p)$ and $t|_{V_p}$ are two elements whose germs in $\mathcal{G}_{X,p}$ are equal. Hence there exists $W_p \subseteq V_p$ containing p such that $\phi(r_p) = t|_{W_p}$ in $\mathcal{G}(W_p)$. Now U is covered by open sets of the form W_p for each $p \in U$. Let $p \in W_p$ and $q \in W_q$. Then both $r_p|_{W_p \cap W_q}$ and $r_q|_{W_p \cap W_q}$ are two sections in $\mathcal{F}(W_p \cap W_q)$ that are sent to $t|_{W_p \cap W_q} \in \mathcal{G}(W_p \cap W_q)$ by

$\phi(W_p \cap W_q)$. By injectivity, they are equal. We conclude that

$$r_p|_{W_p \cap W_q} = r_q|_{W_p \cap W_q}$$

By the gluing axiom, we conclude that there exists a section $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $s|_{W_p} = r_p$. Now $\phi(s)$ and t are two sections in $\mathcal{G}(U)$ such that for any $p \in U$, $\phi(s)|_{W_p} = t|_{W_p}$. By the identity axiom, we conclude that $\phi(s) = t$. ■

Note that the above proposition is very untrue for presheaves because as one can see, proving both injective and surjective requires to use of the sheaf axioms instead of just the presheaf datum.

Proposition 1.3.8

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaves on X . Let $\varphi, \psi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be morphisms. Then $\varphi = \psi$ if and only if for all $p \in X$, we have $\varphi_p = \psi_p$.

Proof

Clearly if $\varphi(U) = \psi(U)$ for all open sets $U \subseteq X$, we must have that the induced map of colimits are equal. So suppose instead that $\varphi_p = \psi_p$ for all $p \in X$. Consider the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}(U) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p & \longrightarrow & \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{G}_p \end{array}$$

where the top and bottom maps are either φ or ψ and their induced product map of stalks.

I claim that the vertical maps are injective. Suppose that $s, t \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ are such that $[(s, U)]_{p \in U} = [(t, U)]_{p \in U}$. This means that for each $p \in U$, we have that $[(s, U)] = [(t, U)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$. This means that there exists an open subset $V_p \subseteq U$ such that $s|_{V_p} = t|_{V_p}$. Now the collection $\{V_p \mid p \in U\}$ forms an open cover of U . Since $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, the identity axiom implies that $s = t$ on U . Hence the map is injective.

Let $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$. Then the left vertical map sends s to $[(s, U)]_{p \in U}$ and $\prod_{p \in U} \varphi_p = \prod_{p \in U} \psi_p$ sends the element to $[(\varphi(U)(s), U)]_{p \in U} = [(\psi(U)(s), U)]_{p \in U}$. Since the right vertical map is injective, we must have $\varphi(U)(s) = \psi(U)(s)$. Hence we have $\varphi = \psi$. ■

Definition 1.3.9 (The Category of Presheaves)

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Define the category of presheaves on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$ to be

$$\mathbf{PC}(X) = \mathbf{Func}(\mathbf{Open}(X)^{\text{op}}, \mathcal{C})$$

Definition 1.3.10 (The Category of Sheaves over a Category) Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category that admits all products. Define the category $\mathcal{C}(X)$ of sheaves on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$ to be the full subcategory of $\mathbf{PC}(X)$ consisting of sheaves on X with values in $\mathcal{C}$.

1.4 Defining Sheaves on a Subcategory of Open Sets

Definition 1.4.1 (Sheaves of a Space on a Subcategory of Open Sets)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{S}$ be a subcategory of $\mathbf{Open}(X)$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category with forgetful functor $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$. A sheaf of X on $\mathcal{S}$ is a contravariant functor $\mathcal{F} : \mathcal{S}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ such that $F \circ \mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

Definition 1.4.2 (The Category of Sheaves on a Space on a Subcategory of Open Sets)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{S}$ be a subcategory of $\mathbf{Open}(X)$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Define the

category of sheaves of X on $\mathcal{S}$

$$\mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{S}}(X)$$

to be the full subcategory of $\text{Hom}_{\mathbf{Cat}}(\mathcal{S}^{\text{op}}, \mathcal{C})$ consisting of sheaves of X on $\mathcal{S}$.

Proposition 1.4.3

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{S}$ be a subcategory of $\mathbf{Open}(X)$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. If $\mathcal{S} \subseteq \mathbf{Open}(X)$ is filtered, then there is an equivalence of categories

$$\mathcal{C}(X) = \mathcal{C}_{\mathcal{S}}(X)$$

An example of $\mathcal{S}$ would be: any base $\mathcal{B}$ of the topology of X .

2 Properties of the Category of Sheaves

2.1 Sheafification

Definition 2.1.1 (Compatible Germs)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Let $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \in \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$. We say that the element is a compatible germ if for all $p \in U$, there exists an open subset $V_p \subseteq U$ such that

$$[(s_p|_{V_p}, V_p)] = [(s_q, U_q)] \in \mathcal{F}_q$$

for all $q \in V_p$.

Lemma 2.1.2

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Let $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \in \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$. Then the element is a compatible germ if and only if there exists an open cover $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ of U together with elements $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that for all $p \in U_i$ for all i , $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_p, U_p)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$.

Proof

Suppose that $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \in \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$ is a compatible germ. Then $\{U_p \mid p \in U\}$ is a valid open cover of U together with the elements $s_p \in \mathcal{F}(U_p)$ so that the latter condition is satisfied.

Conversely, suppose that the latter condition is satisfied. Let $p \in U$. Since $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ is an open cover of U , there exists $i \in I$ such that $p \in U_i$. Then for all $q \in U_i$, we have $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_q, U_q)] \in \mathcal{F}_q$ by assumption. Hence we are done. ■

Thus not only are isomorphism of sheaves determined on the level of stalks, the morphism of sheaves themselves are determined on the level of stalks.

Definition 2.1.3 (Sheafification)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Define the sheafification

$$\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} : \text{Open}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$$

of $\mathcal{F}$ as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$,

$$\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) = \left\{ ((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \in \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p \mid ((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \text{ is a compatible germ} \right\}$$

- For each $V \subseteq U$ an inclusion, there is a unique morphism $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(V)$ that sends $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} \in \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ to

$$((s_p, U_p))_{p \in V}$$

Lemma 2.1.4

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Then $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is a $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaf.

Proof

We first show that $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is a sheaf. Let $\{W_i \mid i \in I\}$ be an open cover for an open set $U \subseteq X$.

For the identity axiom, suppose that $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U}$ and $((t_p, V_p))_{p \in U}$ in $\mathcal{F}(U)$ are such that their restriction to $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(W_i)$ are equal. This means that $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in W_i} = ((t_p, V_p))_{p \in W_i}$ or in other words, that $[(s_p, U_p)] = [(t_p, V_p)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$. Then since $\{W_i \mid i \in I\}$ covers U , we must have $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U} = ((t_p, V_p))_{p \in U}$ in $\mathcal{F}(U)$.

For gluing, suppose that we are given $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in W_i} \in \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(W_i)$ for each $i \in I$ such that restricting to common intersections give equal elements. This means that the element $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U}$ is a well defined element of $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$. ■

Example 2.1.5

Let X be a space. Let S be a set. Then we have

$$\underline{S} = \left(S_{\text{pre}} \right)^{\text{sh}}$$

Definition 2.1.6 (Universal Morphism of Sheafification)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Define the universal morphism of sheafification $\theta_{\mathcal{F}}$ as follows. For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define

$$\theta_{\mathcal{F}}(U) : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$$

by $s \mapsto ((s, U))_{p \in U}$.

Lemma 2.1.7

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Then the following are true.

- $\text{im}(\theta_{\mathcal{F}}) = \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$.
- If $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, then for any open subset $U \subseteq X$, $\theta_{\mathcal{F}}(U) : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is injective.

Proof

- Clearly any element in the image of the map is a compatible germ. Now conversely, suppose that $((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U}$ is a compatible germ. Now $\{U_p \mid p \in U\}$ is an open cover of U . Let $p, q \in U$ be arbitrary. Let $r \in U_p \cap U_q$. Then there exists an open subset $V_r \subseteq U_p$ such that $[(s_p|_{V_r}, V_r)] = [(s_q, U_q)] \in \mathcal{F}_q$. This means that there exists an open subset $W_r \subseteq V_r \cap U_q$ such that $s_p|_{W_r} = s_q|_{W_r}$. Now since $\{W_r \mid r \in U_p \cap U_q\}$ covers $U_p \cap U_q$, we must have that $s_p|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_q|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ by the identity axiom. Then by the gluability axiom, there exists $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ such that $s|_{U_p} = s_p \in \mathcal{F}(U_p)$. Now clearly $((s, U))_{p \in U} = ((s_p, U_p))_{p \in U}$ since $s|_{U_p} = s_p \in \mathcal{F}(U_p)$. Hence the map is surjective.
- Suppose that $s, t \in \mathcal{F}(U)$ are such that $((s, U))_{p \in U} = ((t, U))_{p \in U}$. This means that for each $p \in U$, we have that $[(s, U)] = [(t, U)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$. This means that there exists an open subset $V_p \subseteq U$ such that $s|_{V_p} = t|_{V_p}$. Now the collection $\{V_p \mid p \in U\}$ forms an open cover of U . Since $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf, the identity axiom implies that $s = t$ on U . Hence the map is injective. ■

Lemma 2.1.8

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Then θ induces an isomorphism

$$\theta_p : \mathcal{F}_p \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{F}_p^{\text{sh}}$$

of stalks for each $p \in X$.

Proof

By the universal property of stalks as colimits, the morphism θ_p is defined by $[(s, U)] \mapsto [(((s, U))_{p \in U}, U)]$.

Suppose that $[(((s, U))_{q \in U}, U)] = [(((t, U))_{q \in U}, U)]$. By the definition of the equivalence relation, we have that $((s, U))_{q \in U}$ and $((t, U))_{q \in U}$ agree on U . Hence for each $q \in U$, we have

$[(s, U)] = [(t, U)]$. Again by the definition of the equivalence relation, we have $s = t$ on U . Hence θ_p is injective.

To show that θ_p is surjective, let $[([(s_q, U_q)])_{q \in U}, U] \in \mathcal{F}_p^{\text{sh}}$. Since s is a compatible germ by definition, there exists an open cover $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ of U together with elements $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_q, U_q)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$ for all $q \in U_i$ for all i . In particular, for our already fixed choice of $p \in X$, there exists $i \in I$ and $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_p, U_p)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$. Now $[(f_i, U_i)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$ is mapped to $[([(f_i, U_i)])_{q \in U_i}, U_i]$. I claim that

$$[([(f_i, U_i)])_{q \in U_i}, U_i] = [([(s_q, U_q)])_{q \in U}, U] \in \mathcal{F}_p^{\text{sh}}$$

Indeed, in the intersection $U_i = U_i \cap U$, we have $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_q, U_q)]$ for all $q \in U_i$. by definition. Hence we have $[(f_i, U_i)]_{q \in U_i} = [(s_q, U_q)]_{q \in U_i}$ and hence we have surjectivity. $\blacksquare$

Proposition 2.1.9 (The Universal Property of Sheafification)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Then the sheafification $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ of $\mathcal{F}$ together with the universal morphism θ satisfies the following universal property. For any sheaf $\mathcal{G}$ on X and morphism of presheaves $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, there exists a unique morphism $\varphi^{\text{sh}} : \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F} & \xrightarrow{\theta} & \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \\ & \searrow \varphi & \downarrow \exists! \varphi^{\text{sh}} \\ & & \mathcal{G} \end{array}$$

Moreover, $\mathcal{F}^+$ is the unique (up to unique isomorphism) sheaf of X satisfying the above property.

Proof

Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a sheaf. Let $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism of presheaves. To define a morphism of sheaves $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, we first define it on each open set U and prove that the relevant square diagrams commute. So define $\phi^{\text{sh}}(U) : \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$ for each open set $U \subseteq X$ as follows. For $([(s_p, U_p)])_{p \in U}$ an element in $\prod_{p \in U} \mathcal{F}_p$, the product map $\prod_{p \in U} \phi_p$ sends the our element to $([\phi(U_p)(s_p), U_p])_{p \in U}$. Let $([(s_p, U_p)])_{p \in U}$ be a compatible germ. I claim that $([\phi(U_p)(s_p), U_p])_{p \in U}$ is a compatible germ. By lemma 1.2.6, there exists an open cover $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ of U together with elements in $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that for all $i \in I$ and all $p \in U_i$, $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_p, U_p)]$. Now the elements $\phi(U_i)(f_i)$ for all i proves the claim since ϕ_p maps $[(f_i, U_i)]$ to $[(\phi(U_i)(f_i), U_i)]$, $[(s_p, U_p)] \mapsto [(\phi(U_p)(s_p), U_p)]$ and $[(f_i, U_i)] = [(s_p, U_p)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$ implies that $[(\phi(U_i)(f_i), U_i)] = [(\phi(U_p)(s_p), U_p)]$. By lemma 1.2.9, we obtain a unique element in $\mathcal{G}(U)$. Hence we obtain a map $\phi^{\text{sh}}(U) : \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$.

Now we show that the composite $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is equal to ϕ . Notice that given $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$, it is sent to $([(s, U)])_{p \in U}$ in $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}(U)$ and then to $([(\phi(U)(s), U)])_{p \in U}$ in $\mathcal{G}(U)$. Evidently, $\phi(U)(s) \in \mathcal{G}(U)$ is the unique preimage of $([(\phi(U)(s), U)])_{p \in U}$ of the map in lemma 1.2.7. Hence $s \mapsto \phi(U)(s)$ matches up with the map of presheaves $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$.

It remains to show uniqueness of the morphism ϕ^{sh} . Suppose that $\psi : \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is another morphism of sheaves such that $\phi = \psi \circ \theta$. By the above lemma, θ is an isomorphism at stalks. Hence for all $p \in X$, we have

$$\phi_p \circ \theta_p^{-1} = \psi_p$$

On the other hand, the equation $\phi = \phi^{\text{sh}} \circ \theta$ gives

$$\phi_p \circ \theta_p^{-1} = \phi_p^{\text{sh}}$$

Equating the two gives $\psi_p = \phi_p^{\text{sh}}$ for all $p \in X$. Since $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ are sheaves, By 1.2.6 we conclude that $\psi = \phi^{\text{sh}}$ and so we are done. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.1.10

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be an $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Then the universal morphism $\theta : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is an isomorphism.

Proof

By 1.2.11, we have that θ_p is an isomorphism for all $p \in X$. Hence by 1.2.4, we have that θ is an isomorphism. $\blacksquare$

Thus the theory of compatible germs gives us an explicit way of understanding the elements of a sheaf by a collection of elements in the stalks.

Definition 2.1.11 (The Sheafification Functor)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Define the sheafification functor

$$(-)^{\text{sh}} : \mathbf{PC}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(X)$$

as follows.

- For each presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on X , $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ is the sheafification of $\mathcal{F}$.
- For each morphism of presheaves $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, the morphism of sheaves is given by the universal property of $\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ applied to the composite $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}^{\text{sh}}$.

Proposition 2.1.12

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\text{Forget} : \mathcal{C}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{PC}(X)$ be the forgetful functor. Then there is an adjunction

$$(-)^{\text{sh}} : \mathbf{PC}(X) \xrightleftharpoons{-1} \mathcal{C}(X) : \text{Forget}$$

Proof

The universal property of sheafification gives a map from the right hom set to the left hom set. Conversely, precomposition with the universal morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}$ gives the map to the other direction. Evidently they are inverses of each other. It remains to show that this bijection is natural in both variables. In other words, we ought to show that the following two squares commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{Set}(X)}(\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}, \mathcal{G}) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{PSet}(X)}(\mathcal{F}, \text{Forget}(\mathcal{G})) \\ \uparrow - \circ \varphi^{\text{sh}} & & \uparrow - \circ \varphi \\ \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{Set}(X)}(\mathcal{H}^{\text{sh}}, \mathcal{G}) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{PSet}(X)}(\mathcal{H}, \text{Forget}(\mathcal{G})) \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{Set}(X)}(\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}, \mathcal{G}) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{PSet}(X)}(\mathcal{F}, \text{Forget}(\mathcal{G})) \\ \downarrow \psi \circ - & & \downarrow \text{Forget}(\psi) \circ - \\ \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{Set}(X)}(\mathcal{F}^{\text{sh}}, \mathcal{I}) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \text{Hom}_{\mathbf{PSet}(X)}(\mathcal{F}, \text{Forget}(\mathcal{I})) \end{array}$$

for two morphisms $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ and $\psi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{I}$. Since $\mathbf{Sh}(X)$ is a full subcategory of $\mathbf{PSh}(X)$, clearly the square on the bottom commutes. For the top square, let $\sigma : \mathcal{H}^{\text{sh}} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Following the left and top arrows, we obtain the morphism $\sigma \circ \varphi^{\text{sh}} \circ \theta_{\mathcal{F}}$. Following the bottom and right arrows, we obtain the morphism $\sigma \circ \theta_{\mathcal{H}} \circ \varphi$. I claim that $\varphi^{\text{sh}} \circ \theta_{\mathcal{F}} = \theta_{\mathcal{H}} \circ \varphi$. Indeed, the definition of φ^{sh} as in def 2.1.10 is given by the universal property of sheafification of the composite $\theta_{\mathcal{H}} \circ \varphi$. Hence precomposing φ^{sh} with $\theta_{\mathcal{F}}$ is precisely $\theta_{\mathcal{H}} \circ \varphi$. Thus we are done. $\blacksquare$

2.2 The Category of (Pre)Sheaves as an Abelian Category

Lemma 2.2.1

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category. Let $*$ be the zero object of $\mathcal{A}$. Then the sheaf $\underline{*}$ is the zero object of $\mathcal{A}(X)$.

Proof Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathcal{A}(X)$ be an abelian sheaf. We first show the existence and uniqueness of a morphism $\ast \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$. Suppose that $\varphi : \ast \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ is a morphism. Then for each open set $U \subseteq X$, there is a unique morphism $\varphi(U) : \ast(U) = \ast \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$. Hence φ is unique. Existence is also evident.

Similarly, we show the existence and uniqueness of a morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \ast$. Suppose that $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \ast$ is a morphism. Then for each open set $U \subseteq X$, there is a unique morphism $\varphi(U) : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \ast = \ast(U)$. Hence φ is unique. Existence is also evident. ■

Definition 2.2.2 (The Product Sheaf)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category that admits all products. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaves on X . Define the product $\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G}$ sheaf of $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define $(\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G})(U) = \mathcal{F}(U) \times \mathcal{G}(U)$.
- For each inclusion of open sets $V \subseteq U$, define the morphism $(\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G})(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G})(V)$ by $\text{res}_V^U \times \text{res}_V^U$.

Lemma 2.2.3

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category that admits all products. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaves on X . Then $\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G}$ is the categorical product of $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ in $\mathcal{C}(X)$.

Proof

Firstly, the identity and gluing axiom of $\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G}$ can be checked coordinate wise. Clearly, there are projection morphisms $\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ open set wise. Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a sheaf with morphisms $\mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$. Then by the universal product of products of abelian groups, there is a unique morphism $\mathcal{H}(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G})(U)$ for each open set $U \subseteq X$ such that the composition $\mathcal{H}(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G})(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U), \mathcal{G}(U)$ is equal to $\mathcal{H}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U), \mathcal{G}(U)$ respectively. Then they assemble into a morphism of sheaves $\mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \times \mathcal{G}$. This morphism is unique by construction. ■

Definition 2.2.4 (The Presheaf Kernel)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Define the kernel $\ker(\varphi)$ of φ as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define $\ker(\varphi)(U) = \ker(\varphi(U))$.
- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$ of open sets, define the restriction morphism by the universal property of kernels as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \ker(\varphi(U)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\varphi(U)} & \mathcal{G}(U) \\ \exists! \downarrow & & \text{res}_V^U \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{res}_V^U \\ \ker(\varphi(V)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(V) & \xrightarrow{\varphi(V)} & \mathcal{G}(V) \end{array}$$

Definition 2.2.5 (The Presheaf Cokernel)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Define the cokernel $\text{coker}(\varphi)$ of φ as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define $\text{coker}(\varphi)(U) = \text{coker}(\varphi(U))$.
- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$ of open sets, define the restriction morphism by the universal property of cokernels as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\varphi(U)} & \mathcal{G}(U) & \longrightarrow & \text{coker}(\varphi(U)) \\ \text{res}_V^U \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{res}_V^U & & \downarrow \exists! \\ \mathcal{F}(V) & \xrightarrow{\varphi(V)} & \mathcal{G}(V) & \longrightarrow & \text{coker}(\varphi(V)) \end{array}$$

Proposition 2.2.6

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then the following are true.

- The presheaf $\ker(\varphi)$ is the categorical kernel of φ in $\mathbf{PA}(X)$.
- The presheaf $\operatorname{coker}(\varphi)$ is the categorical cokernel of φ in $\mathbf{PA}(X)$.

Proof ■

Proposition 2.2.7

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then the following are true.

- The presheaf $\ker(\varphi)$ is a sheaf, and is the categorical kernel of φ in $\mathcal{A}(X)$.
- The sheafification of the presheaf $\operatorname{coker}(\varphi)$ is the categorical cokernel of φ in $\mathcal{A}(X)$.

Proof

- Let $U \subseteq X$ be an open set. Let $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ be an open cover of U . Let $f, g \in \ker(\varphi)(U)$ such that $\operatorname{res}_{U_i}^U(f) = \operatorname{res}_{U_i}^U(g)$. Consider the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \ker(\varphi(U)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(U) \\ \operatorname{res}_V^U \downarrow & & \downarrow \operatorname{res}_V^U \\ \ker(\varphi(U_i)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(U_i) \end{array}$$

Consider the images of f and g in $\mathcal{F}(U)$. Since f and g map vertically down to the same element in $\ker(\varphi)(U_i)$, by commutativity of the diagram, the images of f and g in $\mathcal{F}(U)$ map vertically to the same element in $\mathcal{F}(U_i)$. Since this is true for all $i \in I$, the identity property of the sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ implies that the image of f and g in $\mathcal{F}(U)$ are equal. This means that $f - g \in \ker(\varphi(U))$ map to $0 \in \mathcal{F}(U)$. Since $\ker(\varphi)(U)$ is a subgroup of $\mathcal{F}(U)$, we must have $f = g$. This proves the identity property of $\ker(\varphi)$.

- We prove that $\operatorname{coker}(\varphi)^{\operatorname{sh}}$ satisfy the universal property of the cokernel. Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a sheaf on X with values in $\mathcal{A}$. Let $\psi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ be a morphism such that the composite $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ is 0. Consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathcal{F} & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & \mathcal{G} & \longrightarrow & \operatorname{coker}(\varphi) \xrightarrow{\theta_{\operatorname{coker}(\varphi)}} \operatorname{coker}(\varphi)^{\operatorname{sh}} \\ & & & \searrow \psi & \downarrow \exists! \\ & & & & \mathcal{H} \end{array}$$

By the universal property of cokernels in the category of presheaves, there exists a unique morphism $\operatorname{coker}(\varphi) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ such that the relevant diagram commutes. Then by the universal property of sheafification, we obtain the unique morphism required to satisfy the universal property of the cokernel. ■

Proposition 2.2.8

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Let $p \in X$. Then the following are true.

- $\ker(\phi)_p = \ker(\phi_p)$.
- There is a natural isomorphism $\operatorname{coker}(\varphi)_p^{\operatorname{sh}} \cong \operatorname{coker}(\varphi_p)$.

Proof I claim that the induced map $\ker(\phi)_p \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p$ is the zero map. Indeed, the map $\ker(\phi)_p \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p$ is induced by the maps $\ker(\phi)(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$ for each open set $U \subseteq X$, which composes with $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(U)$ to give the zero map. Hence by the universal property of the kernel of ϕ_p , we obtain a unique morphism $\ker(\phi)_p \rightarrow \ker(\phi_p)$. Since the morphism $\ker(\phi) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ is the inclusion map for each open set, the morphism $\ker(\phi)_p \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_p$ is also the inclusion map and so $\ker(\phi_p) \subseteq \ker(\phi_p)$. Conversely, suppose that $[(s, U)] \in \ker(\phi_p)$. Then we have $[(\phi(U)(s), U)] = [(0, V)]$ for some $V \subseteq X$ open. This means that there exists $W \subseteq U \cap V$ open

such that $\phi(U)(s)|_W = 0|_W$. But we have

$$\begin{aligned} 0|_W &= \phi(U)(s)|_W \\ &= \text{res}_W^U(\phi(U)(s)) \\ &= \phi(W)(\text{res}_W^U(s)) & (\phi \text{ is a morphism}) \\ &= \phi(W)(s|_W) \end{aligned}$$

and so $s|_W \in \ker(\phi)(W)$. By definition of the kernel of ϕ , we have $[(s|_W, W)] \in \ker(\phi)_p$. But $[(s|_W, W)] = [(s, U)]$ and so we are done.

For cokernels, we invoke the fact that colimits commutes with colimits. ■

Proposition 2.2.9

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Then $\mathcal{A}(X)$ is an abelian category.

Proof We showed that $\mathcal{A}(X)$ has a zero object by 2.2.1. The hom sets have the structure of an abelian group by open set wise, point wise addition. Thus addition distributes over composition. Finite products are given in def 2.2.2 and lmm 2.2.3. Kernels and cokernels are given above for arbitrary morphisms. Now for any monomorphism $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ of sheaves, ■

Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category. Let f be a morphism. Recall the following equivalent definitions.

- f is injective if and only if $\ker(\varphi) = 0$ if and only if f is a monomorphism.
- f is surjective if and only if $\text{coker}(f) = 0$ if and only if f is an epimorphism.
- f is an isomorphism if and only if f is injective and surjective.

If $\mathcal{A} = \mathbf{Set}$ recall also that injective functions and monomorphisms coincide, while surjective functions and monomorphisms coincide.

Definition 2.2.10 (The Image Presheaf)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Define the image presheaf $\text{im}(\varphi)$ by the following.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define $\text{im}(\varphi)(U) = \text{im}(\varphi(U))$.
- For each inclusion of open sets $V \subseteq U$, define $\text{im}(\varphi)(U) \rightarrow \text{im}(\varphi)(V)$ by the universal property of kernels as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \text{im}(\varphi)(U) = \ker(\mathcal{G}(U) \rightarrow \text{coker}(f)(U)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}(U) & \longrightarrow & \text{coker}(\varphi)(U) \\ \exists! \downarrow & & \text{res}_V^U \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{res}_V^U \\ \text{im}(\varphi)(V) = \ker(\mathcal{G}(V) \rightarrow \text{coker}(f)(V)) & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{G}(V) & \longrightarrow & \text{coker}(\varphi)(V) \end{array}$$

Proposition 2.2.11

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then the following are true.

- The image presheaf $\text{im}(\varphi)$ is the image of φ in $\mathbf{P}\mathcal{A}(X)$.
- The sheafification of the image presheaf $\text{im}(\varphi)^{\text{sh}}$ is the image of φ in $\mathcal{A}(X)$.
- There is a natural isomorphism $\text{im}(\varphi_p) = \text{im}(\varphi)_p$.

Proof

-
- Since the kernel of the cokernel is the cokernel of the kernel in an abelian category, we have that

$$\text{im}(\varphi) = \ker(\text{coker}(\varphi)^{\text{sh}}) = \text{coker}(\ker(\varphi))^{\text{sh}} = \ker(\text{coker}(\varphi))^{\text{sh}}$$

- Since taking kernels and cokernels commute with stalk, and sheafification preserves stalks, we conclude. ■

2.3 Exact Sequences of Sheaves

From now on, we focus on the abelian category of sheaves and not presheaves. Therefore we will drop the sheafification symbol for cokernels and images since they mean the abelian categorical object that is the cokernel and the image.

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Since $\mathcal{A}(X)$ is an abelian category, it makes sense to talk about chain complexes and in particular, exact sequences of sheaves. Recall that a sequence of sheaves $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ is exact if $\text{im}(\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}) = \ker(\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H})$.

Proposition 2.3.1

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Suppose the following

$$\mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}$$

is a sequence of $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Then the sequence is exact if and only if the following sequence of stalks

$$\mathcal{F}_p \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}_p \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}_p$$

is exact for all $p \in X$.

Proof We have that $\text{im}(\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}) = \ker(\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H})$ and taking stalks gives $\text{im}(\mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p) = \ker(\mathcal{G}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_p)$. Since taking stalks commute with images and kernels, we are done. Conversely, suppose that for all $p \in X$, we have $\text{im}(\mathcal{F}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_p) = \ker(\mathcal{G}_p \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_p)$. Since taking stalks commute with kernels and images, this show that $\text{im}(\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G})_p = \ker(\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H})_p$. But two sheaves are isomorphic if and only if the stalks are isomorphic, we are done. ■

Thus the functor

$$(-)_p : \mathcal{A}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$$

of taking stalks is exact.

Proposition 2.3.2 Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let the following be a sequence of $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X :

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \xrightarrow{\varphi} \mathcal{G} \xrightarrow{\psi} \mathcal{H}$$

Then the above sequence is exact if and only if the following sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{\varphi(U)} \mathcal{G}(U) \xrightarrow{\psi(U)} \mathcal{H}(U)$$

of local sections is exact for any open set $U \subseteq X$.

Proof

Suppose that the given sequence of sheaves is exact. This means that $\ker(\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}) = 0$. Let $U \subseteq X$ be an open set. Then we have $0 = \ker(\varphi)(U) = \ker(\varphi(U))$. On the other hand, notice that $\text{im}(\varphi) = \ker(\psi)$ implies that $\psi_p \circ \varphi_p = 0$ for all $p \in X$. Recall that the image is sheafified, meaning that an element in the image is

$$[(s_p, U_p)]_{p \in U} \in \prod_{p \in U} \text{im}(\varphi)_p$$

This means that $[(s_p, U_p)] \in \text{im}(\varphi)_p$. So there exists $[(t_p, V_p)] \in \mathcal{F}_p$ such that $\varphi_p([(t_p, V_p)]) = [(s_p, U_p)]$. Also, since the sheafification of a sheaf is isomorphic to the original sheaf, without loss

of generality, Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}\psi(U) (\varphi_p([(t_p, V_p)]))_{p \in U} &= \psi(U) ([(\varphi(V_p)(t_p), V_p)]_{p \in U}) \\ &= ([(\psi(U)(\varphi(U)(t_p)), V_p)]_{p \in U}) \\ &= ([(\psi \circ \varphi(U)(t_p), V_p)]_{p \in U}) \\ &= 0\end{aligned}$$

Thus $\text{im}(\varphi)(U) \subseteq \ker(\psi)(U)$. Let $s \in \ker(\psi)(U)$. ■

Thus the functor

$$(-)(U) : \mathcal{A}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{A}$$

is left exact. It is in general not right exact.

Proposition 2.3.3

Let X be a topological space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then the following are equivalent.

- φ is injective (a monomorphism).
- For each $U \subseteq X$ open, $\varphi(U)$ is injective.
- For each $p \in X$, φ_p is injective.

Proof When $\mathcal{A}$ is not **Set**, (1) $\iff$ (2) is a special case of 2.3.2. (1) $\iff$ (3) is a special case of 2.3.1. ■

Proposition 2.3.4

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaves on X . Let $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be a morphism. Then the following are equivalent.

- φ is surjective (an epimorphism).
- For each $U \subseteq X$ open and for every $g \in \mathcal{G}(U)$, there exists an open cover $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ of U and there exists $f_i \in \mathcal{F}(U_i)$ such that $\varphi(U_i)(f_i) = g|_{U_i}$.
- For each $p \in X$, φ_p is surjective.
- There exists a base $\mathcal{B} = \{B_i \mid i \in I\}$ of X such that $\varphi(B_i)$ is surjective for all $i \in I$.

2.4 Adjunctions between Sheaves of Different Spaces

Definition 2.4.1 (Direct Image Sheaf)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -presheaf on X . Define the direct image of sheaf

$$f_*\mathcal{F} : \text{Open}(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq Y$, define $f_*\mathcal{F}(U) = \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U))$.
- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$, define the induced map

$$\mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U)) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(V))$$

to be the map $\mathcal{F}(\text{incl.} : f^{-1}(V) \hookrightarrow f^{-1}(U))$.

Proposition 2.4.2

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaf. Then $f_*\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf on Y .

Proof

It is clear that $f_*\mathcal{F}$ is a presheaf on Y . We need to check the identity and gluing axiom. By 1.3.4, without loss of generality we can assume that $\mathcal{C} = \text{Set}$.

Identity: Let $U \subseteq Y$ be an open set. Let $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ be an open cover of U . Denote the inclusion maps by $\iota_i : U_i \rightarrow U$. Let $s, t \in f_*\mathcal{F}(U)$. Suppose that $f_*\mathcal{F}(\iota_i)(s) = f_*\mathcal{F}(\iota_i)(t)$ for all $i \in I$. This means that $s, t \in \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U))$ is such that the images of s, t in $\mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U_i))$ are equal for all $i \in I$. Since $\{f^{-1}(U_i)\}$ is an open cover of $f^{-1}(U)$ and $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf on X , this means that $s = t$.

Gluing: Let $U \subseteq Y$ be an open set. Let $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ be an open cover of U . Suppose that $s_i \in f_*\mathcal{F}(U_i) = \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U_i))$ is such that the images of s_i and s_j in $f_*\mathcal{F}(U_i \cap U_j) = \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U_i \cap U_j))$ agree for all $i, j \in I$. Since $\{f^{-1}(U_i)\}$ is an open cover of $f^{-1}(U)$ and $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf on X , we conclude that there exists $s \in \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U)) = f_*\mathcal{F}(U)$ such that the image of s in $\mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U_i)) = f_*\mathcal{F}(U_i)$ is s_i for all $i \in I$. Thus the gluing axiom is satisfied. ■

Example 2.4.3 (Skyscraper Sheaf)

Let X be a space. Let $p \in X$. Let S be a set. Let $\underline{S}$ be the constant sheaf on $\{p\}$. Define the skyscraper sheaf of X at p to be the pushforward

$$\iota_*\underline{S}(U) = \underline{S}(\iota^{-1}(U))$$

where $\iota : \{p\} \hookrightarrow X$ is the inclusion map.

Definition 2.4.4 (The Direct Image Sheaf Functor)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaf on X . Define the direct image sheaf functor

$$f_* : \mathcal{C}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(Y)$$

by the following data.

- For each sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of X , $f_*\mathcal{F}$ is the direct image sheaf on Y .
- For each morphism $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, $f_*\varphi : f_*\mathcal{F} \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{G}$ is the morphism given by

$$\varphi(f^{-1}(U)) : \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(U)) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(f^{-1}(U))$$

Definition 2.4.5 (Inverse Image Sheaf)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a sheaf that admits all filtered colimits. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a sheaf on Y . Define the inverse image sheaf $f^{-1}\mathcal{G}$ to be the sheafification of the presheaf on X defined as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, let $\mathcal{J}(U) \subseteq \mathbf{Open}(X)$ be the full subcategory consisting of open sets of Y the contain $f(U)$. Then the presheaf sends U to $\lim_{W \in \mathcal{J}(U)} \mathcal{G}(W)$.
- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$, define the induced map to be induced by the universal property of the limit.

Proposition 2.4.6

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a sheaf on Y . Then the inverse image sheaf $f^{-1}\mathcal{G}$ is a sheaf.

Definition 2.4.7 (The Inverse Image Sheaf Functor)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a sheaf that admits all filtered colimits. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Define the inverse image sheaf functor

$$f^{-1} : \mathcal{C}(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(X)$$

by the following data.

- For each sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of Y , $f^{-1}\mathcal{F}$ is the inverse image sheaf on X .
- For each morphism $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, the morphism $f^{-1}\mathcal{F} \rightarrow f^{-1}\mathcal{G}$ is induced by the universal property of limits.

Example 2.4.8

Let Y be a space. Let $p \in Y$. Let $\iota : \{p\} \hookrightarrow Y$ be the inclusion map. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a sheaf on Y . Then we have

$$(\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G})(\{p\}) = \mathcal{G}_p$$

Proposition 2.4.9

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Then there is an adjunction

$$f^{-1} : \mathcal{C}(Y) \overset{\perp}{\rightleftarrows} \mathcal{C}(X) : f_*$$

Corollary 2.4.10

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaf of Y . Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$(f^{-1}\mathcal{G})_p \cong \mathcal{G}_{f(p)}$$

for any $p \in X$.

Proof f^{-1} is a left adjoint and stalks are colimits. Since left adjoints preserve colimits we are done. ■

Example 2.4.11

Let X be a space. Let $U \subseteq X$ be an open subset. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of sets on X . Let $p \in U$. Then we have

$$(\mathcal{F}|_U)_p \cong \mathcal{F}_p$$

Proof Follows from the above corollary. ■

Lemma 2.4.12

Let Y be a space. Let $U \subseteq Y$ be an open set. Let $\iota : U \hookrightarrow Y$ be the inclusion map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a $\mathcal{C}$ -sheaf on Y . Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G} \cong \mathcal{G}|_U$$

Proof Write $\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G}_{\text{pre}}$ the inverse image sheaf before sheafification. Recall that before sheafification, for $W \subseteq U$ an open set we have $(\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G}_{\text{pre}})(W) = \text{colim}_{V \supseteq W} \mathcal{G}(V)$. Since W is the initial object in the category of open sets containing W , we have that the colimit is equal to the terminal object. Hence $(\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G}_{\text{pre}})(W) = \mathcal{G}(W)$. Since $\mathcal{G}$ is already a sheaf, sheafification gives a natural isomorphism $\iota^{-1}\mathcal{G} \cong \iota^{-1}\mathcal{G}_{\text{pre}}$ and the latter is equal to $\mathcal{G}|_U$. ■

Proposition 2.4.13

Let X, Y be spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a map. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an algebraic category. Then $\iota^{-1} : \mathcal{C}(Y) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}(X)$ is an exact functor.

2.5 Enriching the Category of Sheaves with Sheaves

Definition 2.5.1 (The Sheaf of Local Homomorphisms)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be an abelian category that is an algebraic category. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be $\mathcal{A}$ -sheaves on X . Define the sheaf hom

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$$

from $\mathcal{F}$ to $\mathcal{G}$ as follows.

- For each $U \subseteq X$ open subset,

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})(U) = \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{A}(U)}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$$

- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$ of open subsets, define

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})(V)$$

by

$$\{\sigma_A : \mathcal{F}|_U(A) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_U(A) \mid A \subseteq U \text{ open}\} \mapsto \{\sigma_A \mid A \subseteq V \text{ open}\}$$

Proposition 2.5.2

$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, -)$ is left exact. $\mathcal{H}om(-, \mathcal{G})$ is right exact.

2.6 Ringed Spaces

Definition 2.6.1 (Ringed Space)

A ringed space is a topological space X with a sheaf of rings $\mathcal{O}_X$ on X .

Definition 2.6.2 (Morphisms of Ringed Spaces) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ and $(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. A morphism of ringed spaces from $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ to $(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ is a pair $(f, f^\#)$ of continuous map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and a map $f^\# : \mathcal{O}_Y \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{O}_X$ of sheaves of rings on Y .

Definition 2.6.3 (Locally Ringed Spaces)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. We say that X is a locally ringed space if for all $p \in X$, $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is a local ring.

Suppose that $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ and $(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ are locally ringed spaces. Given a point $p \in X$, we obtain induced maps

$$f^\# : \mathcal{O}_Y(V) \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{O}_X(f^{-1}(V))$$

for any neighbourhood V of $f(p)$. Taking the colimit, we obtain a map

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y,f(p)} = \text{colim}_V \mathcal{O}_Y(V) \rightarrow \text{colim}_V \mathcal{O}_X(f^{-1}(V))$$

As V ranges through the neighbourhood of $f(p)$, $f^{-1}(V)$ ranges over a subset of the neighbourhoods of p so that we obtain a map

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y,f(p)} = \text{colim}_V \mathcal{O}_Y(V) \rightarrow \text{colim}_V \mathcal{O}_X(f^{-1}(V)) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,p}$$

Definition 2.6.4 (Morphisms of Locally Ringed Spaces) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ and $(Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be locally ringed spaces. Then a morphism of locally ringed spaces is a morphism of ringed spaces such that for each $p \in X$, the induced map of local rings

$$f_p^\# : \mathcal{O}_{Y,f(p)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X,p}$$

is a local homomorphism of local rings.

Definition 2.6.5 (The Category of Locally Ringed Spaces)

Define the category **LRS** of locally ringed spaces as follows.

- The objects are locally ringed spaces.
- The morphisms are morphisms of locally ringed spaces.
- Composition is given by the composition of continuous functions and composition of natural transformations.

3 Modules over a Sheaf

3.1 The Sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules

Definition 3.1.1 (Presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. We say that an **Ab**-presheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of X is a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules if the following are true.

- For every open set $U \subseteq X$, $\mathcal{F}(U)$ is an $\mathcal{O}_X(U)$ -module
- For each inclusion of open sets $V \subseteq U$, the restriction homomorphism $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(V)$ is such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{O}_X(U) \times \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\text{action}} & \mathcal{F}(U) \\ \text{res}_{U,V} \times \text{res}_{U,V} \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{res}_{U,V} \\ \mathcal{O}_X(V) \times \mathcal{F}(V) & \xrightarrow{\text{action}} & \mathcal{F}(V) \end{array}$$

Definition 3.1.2 (Sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules if $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf.

Lemma 3.1.3

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Let $p \in X$. Then $\mathcal{F}_p$ is an $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ -module.

Proof

■

Definition 3.1.4 (Morphisms of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules)

Definition 3.1.5 (Induced Morphism of Stalks)

3.2 Sheafification of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules

3.3 The Category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules is an Abelian Category

Definition 3.3.1 (The Category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Define the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ to consist of the following data.

- The objects consists sheaves of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules.
- The morphisms are just morphisms of sheaves between $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules.
- Composition is given by the composition of morphisms of sheaves.

Kernels, Cokernels (instead of defining it, prove that the abelian sheaves are actually sheaves of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules). Commuting with stalks.

Proposition 3.3.2

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Then $\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is an abelian category.

Proposition 3.3.3

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let the following be a sequence

$$\mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}$$

of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Then the sequence is exact if and only if it is exact as a sequence of **Ab**-sheaves.

Exactness with stalks. Left exactness of taking sections. Checking Injectivity and Surjectivity.

3.4 Tensor-Hom Adjunction

Definition 3.4.1 (The Sheaf of Local Sections)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G} \in \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$. Define the sheaf hom from $\mathcal{F}$ to $\mathcal{G}$ to be the sheaf

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$$

defined as follows.

- Each open set U is sent to the abelian group

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})(U) = \mathcal{H}om_{\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$$

- For each inclusion of open sets $V \hookrightarrow U$, define the morphism

$$\mathcal{H}om_{\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}om_{\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}}(\mathcal{F}|_V, \mathcal{G}|_V)$$

as follows. A morphism of sheaves $\phi : \mathcal{F}|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_U$ is sent to the restriction $\phi|_V : \mathcal{F}|_V \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_V$.

Definition 3.4.2 (Tensor Products)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ be sheaves of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Define the tensor product $\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{G}$ of $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ to be the sheafification of the sheaf defined as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define $(\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{G})(U) = \mathcal{F}(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X(U)} \mathcal{G}(U)$.
- For each inclusion of open sets $V \subseteq U$, define the morphism $(\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{G})(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{G})(V)$ by

Tensor-hom adjunction.

Tensor products commute with stalks.

3.5 Functoriality of the Category of Modules over a Sheaf

Lemma 3.5.1

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of ringed spaces. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Then $f_*\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -modules.

Definition 3.5.2 (The Inverse Image Module)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module. Define the inverse image module of $\mathcal{G}$ to be

$$f^*\mathcal{G} = f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \otimes_{f^{-1}\mathcal{O}_Y} \mathcal{O}_X$$

Lemma 3.5.3

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be an $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module. Then $f^*\mathcal{G}$ is a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules.

Definition 3.5.4 (The Inverse Image Module Functor)

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism. Define the inverse image module functor

$$f^* : \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_Y} \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$$

as follows.

- For $\mathcal{G}$ an $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module, $f^*\mathcal{G}$ is the inverse image module.
- For $\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ a morphism of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -modules, define $f^*\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f^*\mathcal{H}$ by the induced morphism from $f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f^{-1}\mathcal{H}$.

Proposition 3.5.5

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X), (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ be ringed spaces. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of ringed spaces. Then

there is an adjunction given by

$$f^* : \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_Y} \xrightleftharpoons{\perp} \mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{O}_X} : f_*$$

Exactness of inverse image functor

3.6 Quasi-Coherent Sheaves

Quasi-coherent sheaves and coherent sheaves has extremely abstract definitions. If one is only interested in the case of Algebraic Geometry, then there is a very nice explicit way of defining it, so readers may skip this part.

Definition 3.6.1 (Quasi-Coherent Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is a quasi-coherent sheaf if for all $p \in X$, there exists an open neighbourhood $U \subseteq X$ such that there is an exact sequence:

$$\mathcal{O}_X^{\otimes I}|_U \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X^{\otimes J}|_U \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}|_U \longrightarrow 0$$

for some countable indexing sets I and J .

Definition 3.6.2 (The Category of Quasi-Coherent Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Define the category of quasi-coherent sheaves

$$\mathbf{QCoh}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$$

over $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ as follows.

- The objects are the quasi-coherent sheaves $\mathcal{F}$ over $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$
- The morphisms are morphisms between sheaves of modules. This means that if $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ are quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, then a morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a natural transformation $\lambda : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ that respects the module structure.
- Composition is given by the composition of sheaves

Definition 3.6.3 (Sheaf of Finite Type) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf of finite type if for all $p \in X$, there exists an open neighbourhood $U \subseteq X$ such that there is a surjective morphism

$$\mathcal{O}_X^{\otimes n}|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{F}|_U$$

for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Definition 3.6.4 (Coherent Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is coherent if the following are true.

- $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf of finite type.
- For any $U \subseteq X$ and any morphism

$$\varphi : \mathcal{O}_X^{\otimes n}|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{F}|_U$$

of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, then kernel of φ is a sheaf of finite type.

Definition 3.6.5 (The Category of Quasi-Coherent Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Define the category of quasi-coherent sheaves

$$\mathbf{Coh}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$$

over $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ as follows.

- The objects are the coherent sheaves $\mathcal{F}$ over $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$
- The morphisms are morphisms between sheaves of modules. This means that if $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ are quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, then a morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is a natural transformation $\lambda : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ that respects the module structure.

- Composition is given by the composition of sheaves

Theorem 3.6.6 Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Then $\text{Coh}_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ is an abelian category.

Proposition 3.6.7 Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let the following

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of sheaves. If two of the three sheaves are coherent, then so is the last one.

3.7 Locally Free Sheaves

Definition 3.7.1 (Free and Locally Free Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{A})$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a $\mathcal{A}$ -module. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is free if there is an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{F} \cong \mathcal{A}^{\oplus n}$$

of sheaves. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is locally free if X has an open cover $\{U_i \mid i \in I\}$ such that for each U_i , there is an isomorphism

$$\mathcal{F}|_{U_i} \cong (\mathcal{A}|_{U_i})^{\oplus n}$$

of sheaves. In this case we say that the rank of $\mathcal{F}$ is n .

Lemma 3.7.2 If X is connected then the rank of a locally free sheaf on X is constant.

Proposition 3.7.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{O})$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}$ -modules. Then $\mathcal{F}$ is locally free of rank r if and only if

$$\mathcal{F}_p \cong \mathcal{O}_{X,p}^r$$

for all $p \in X$.

Definition 3.7.4 (The Category of Locally Free Sheaves) Let $(X, \mathcal{A})$ be a ringed space. Define the category of locally free sheaves Loc_n of rank n over X as follows.

- The objects are the locally free sheaves of rank n over X
- The morphisms are the morphisms of sheaves of modules
- Composition is given by the composition of morphisms of sheaves.

3.8 Invertible Sheaves

Definition 3.8.1 (Invertible Sheaf) Let X be a ringed space. We say that a sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on X is invertible if it is a locally free sheaf on rank 1.

Theorem 3.8.2 Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Then the following are equivalent characterization of a sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules $\mathcal{F}$

- $\mathcal{F}$ is invertible
- There exists a sheaf G such that $\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} G \cong \mathcal{O}_X$
- $\mathcal{F} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{F}^\vee \cong \mathcal{O}_X$

Proposition 3.8.3 Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{G}$ be invertible sheaves on X . Then

$$\mathcal{F} \otimes \mathcal{G}$$

is also an invertible sheaf.

Definition 3.8.4 (The Picard Group) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Define the Picard group of X to be the set

$$\mathrm{Pic}(X) = \{\mathcal{L} \mid \mathcal{L} \text{ is an invertible sheaf on } X\}$$

together with the tensor product $\otimes$.

4 Sheaf Cohomology

4.1 The Global Section Functor

Definition 4.1.1 (Global Section Functor) Let X be a space. Define the global section functor to be the functor $\Gamma(X, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ defined as follows.

- A sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of groups on X is sent to $\Gamma(X, \mathcal{F}) = \mathcal{F}(X)$
- For a morphism of sheaves $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, $\Gamma(X, -)$ sends it to the ring homomorphism $\phi(X) : \mathcal{F}(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(X)$

In general, we can define functor by sending every sheaf to a the local section of a chosen open set. This operation in general is left exact. This means that we have the following proposition.

Corollary 4.1.2 Let X be a space. The global section functor $\Gamma(X, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ is a left exact functor.

Proof The global section functor is a special case of the above proposition. ■

Definition 4.1.3 (Cohomology Functors) Let X be a space. Define the cohomology functors

$$H^i(X, -) = R^i\Gamma(X, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$$

of X to be the right derived functors of $\Gamma(X, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$. For any sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of abelian groups on X , the groups $H^i(X, \mathcal{F})$ are called the cohomology groups of $\mathcal{F}$.

Proposition 4.1.4 Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Then the derived functors of

$$\Gamma(X, -) : {}_{\mathcal{O}_X}\mathbf{Mod}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$$

coincide with the derived functors of $\Gamma(X, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$.

Thus there is no distinction in considering the cohomology groups of sheaf of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules and when considering them as simply a sheaf of abelian groups.

4.2 Flasque Sheaves

Definition 4.2.1 (Flasque Sheaves) A sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on a space X is said to be flasque if for every pair of open sets $V \subset U$, the restriction map $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(V)$ is surjective.

Lemma 4.2.2 If $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is a ringed space, then any injective $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module is flasque.

Lemma 4.2.3 Let X be a space and let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{F}', \mathcal{F}''$ be sheaves on X such that there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0$$

of sheaves. Then the following are true.

- If $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{F}'$ are flasque, then $\mathcal{F}''$ is flasque.
- If $\mathcal{F}$ is flasque, then for any $U \subseteq X$ open, there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{\phi} \mathcal{F}'(U) \xrightarrow{\psi} \mathcal{F}''(U) \longrightarrow 0$$

Proof Suppose that $\mathcal{F}$ and $\mathcal{F}'$ are flasque. Then by naturality we obtain a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(U) & \xrightarrow{\phi(U)} & \mathcal{F}'(U) & \xrightarrow{\psi(U)} & \mathcal{F}''(U) \longrightarrow 0 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}(V) & \xrightarrow{\phi(V)} & \mathcal{F}'(V) & \xrightarrow{\psi(V)} & \mathcal{F}''(V) \longrightarrow 0 \end{array}$$

for any $V \subseteq U$ open sets. Let $s \in \mathcal{F}''(V)$. Then by surjectivity of $\psi(V)$ and $\mathcal{F}'(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}'(V)$, there exists $t \in \mathcal{F}'(U)$ that maps correspondingly by the same maps to s . Then using the map $\phi(U)$ we can send s to an element $r \in \mathcal{F}''(U)$ such that r is sent to s under the map $\mathcal{F}''(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}''(V)$. Thus this map is surjective and $\mathcal{F}''$ is flasque.

Now suppose that $\mathcal{F}$ is flasque. ■

Proposition 4.2.4 Let X be a space and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . If $\mathcal{F}$ is flasque then $\mathcal{F}$ is acyclic for $\Gamma(X, -)$. Explicitly, this means that

$$H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$$

for all $i > 0$.

Proof Since $\mathbf{Ab}(X)$ has enough injective objects, suppose that $\mathcal{I}$ is an injective object of $\mathbf{Ab}(X)$ such that $\mathcal{F}$ is a subobject of $\mathcal{I}$. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be the quotient sheaf $\mathcal{F}/\mathcal{I}$. Then there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{I} \longrightarrow \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow 0$$

By lemma 3.2.2, $\mathcal{I}$ is flasque. By 3.2.3, $\mathcal{G}$ is flasque. By 3.2.3, there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(X) \longrightarrow \mathcal{I}(X) \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}(X) \longrightarrow 0$$

Since $\mathcal{I}$ is injective, we have that $H^i(X, \mathcal{I}) = 0$ for all $i > 0$. By passing to the long exact sequence in cohomology, we deduce that $H^1(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ and $H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = H^{i-1}(X, \mathcal{G})$ for each $i \geq 2$. Applying the same method again gives $H^1(X, \mathcal{G}) = 0$. Thus by induction, we conclude that $H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ for all $i > 0$. ■

Acyclic sheaves are useful because they help compute sheaf cohomology. Recall from Homological Algebra that

$$H^i(X; \mathcal{F}) = H^i(\Gamma(X, \mathcal{I}^\bullet))$$

if $\mathcal{I}^\bullet$ is an acyclic resolution of $\mathcal{F}$.

4.3 Godement Resolution

Definition 4.3.1 (The Godement Sheaf)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf on X . Define the Godement sheaf $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F}) : \mathbf{Open}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ as follows.

- For each open set $U \subseteq X$, define

$$\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})(U) = \prod_{x \in U} \mathcal{F}_x$$

- For each inclusion $V \subseteq U$, define the induced map $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})(V)$ to be the restriction map.

Lemma 4.3.2

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf on X . Then $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})$ is a flasque sheaf.

Definition 4.3.3 (Canonical Morphism)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf on X . Define the canonical morphism $\alpha_{\mathcal{F}} : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})$ by $\alpha_{\mathcal{F}} : \mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})(U)$ the formula

$$s \mapsto (s_x)_{x \in U}$$

Definition 4.3.4 (The Godement Functor)

Let X be a space. Define the Godement functor $\mathrm{Gd} : \mathbf{Ab}(X) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ as follows.

- Each sheaf $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ is sent to the godement sheaf $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})$.
- Each morphism $\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ is sent to the morphism of sheaves defined by the product of the induced map on stalks.

Proposition 4.3.5

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf. Then $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})$ is flasque.

Definition 4.3.6 (Godement Resolution)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf. Define the Godement resolution $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^\bullet$ of $\mathcal{F}$ as follows.

- Define $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^0 = \mathcal{F}$.
- For each $n \in \mathbb{N}^+$, define $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^n = \mathrm{Gd}(\mathrm{coker}(\alpha_{\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^{n-1}}))$.
- Define the morphisms $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^n \rightarrow \mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^{n+1}$ to be $\alpha_{\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^n}$.

Corollary 4.3.7

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F} \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$ be a sheaf. Then $\mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^\bullet$ is an acyclic resolution for $\Gamma(X, -)$.

Consequently, the sheaf cohomology of $\mathcal{F}$ acquires the formula

$$H^i(X; \mathcal{F}) = H^i(\Gamma(X, \mathrm{Gd}(\mathcal{F})^\bullet))$$

4.4 Čech Cohomology

Definition 4.4.1 (Čech Complex) Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{U} = \{U_i | i \in I\}$ an open cover of X where I is an indexing set. For any $(i_0, \dots, i_k) \in I^{k+1}$, denote

$$U_{i_0, \dots, i_k} = U_{i_0} \cap U_{i_1} \cap \dots \cap U_{i_k}$$

Define for each k ,

$$C^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) = \prod_{(i_0, \dots, i_k) \in I^{k+1}} \mathcal{F}(U_{i_0, \dots, i_k})$$

Furthermore, define a boundary map $d : C^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow C^{k+1}(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$ by

$$c_{i_0, \dots, i_k} \xrightarrow{d} \sum_{s=0}^{k+1} (-1)^s \mathrm{res}(c_{i_0, \dots, \hat{i}_s, \dots, i_{k+1}})$$

Define the Čech complex to be $(C^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}), d)$.

Lemma 4.4.2 For any space X and any open cover $\mathcal{U}$ of X , $(C^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}), d)$ is indeed a chain complex.

Definition 4.4.3 (Čech Cohomology) Let $(C^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}), d)$ be a Čech complex. Define the k th cohomology group of it to be

$$\check{H}^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) = \frac{\ker(C^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow C^{k+1}(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}))}{\mathrm{im}(C^{k-1}(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow C^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}))} = H(C^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}), d)$$

Lemma 4.4.4 For any Čech complex, we have that $\check{H}^0(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) = \mathcal{F}(X)$.

Proposition 4.4.5 Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{U}$ an open cover of X . If the open sets $U_{i_0, \dots, i_k}$ satisfy that $H^k(U_{i_0, \dots, i_k}, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ for all $k > 0$, then

$$H^k(X, \mathcal{F}) = \check{H}^k(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$$

Definition 4.4.6 (The Sheafified Čech Complex)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of X . Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Define the sheafified Čech complex $\mathcal{C}^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$ by the following.

- For each $p \in \mathbb{N}$, define

$$\mathcal{C}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) = \prod_{i_0 < \dots < i_p} \iota_{U_{i_0, \dots, i_p}}(U_{i_0, \dots, i_p}) \in \mathbf{Ab}(X)$$

where $\iota_U : U \hookrightarrow X$ denotes the inclusion map for an open subset $U \subseteq X$.

- Define the boundary map $d : \mathcal{C}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^{p+1}(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$ to be the sheafified version of the boundary map in the Čech complex.

Note that by construction, we have $\Gamma(X, \mathcal{C}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})) = \mathcal{C}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$.

Lemma 4.4.7

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of X . Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Then the following are true.

- $\mathcal{C}^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$ is a resolution of $\mathcal{F}$.
- If X is flasque, then $\mathcal{C}^\bullet(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F})$ is a flasque (and hence acyclic) resolution of $\mathcal{F}$.

Note that the above lemma implies that $\check{H}^i(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) = H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ if $\mathcal{F}$ is flasque.

Lemma 4.4.8

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of X . Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Then there exists a map

$$\check{H}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow H^p(X, \mathcal{F})$$

that is natural in $\mathcal{F}$ for all $p \in \mathbb{N}$.

Lemma 4.4.9 (Leray)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be an open cover of X . Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Suppose that for any $U_{i_0, \dots, i_p}$, we have $H^k(U_{i_0, \dots, i_p}, \mathcal{F}_{U_{i_0, \dots, i_p}}) = 0$ for all $k, p \in \mathbb{N}$. Then the above natural maps are isomorphisms

$$\check{H}^p(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \cong H^p(X, \mathcal{F})$$

Proposition 4.4.10

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf on X . Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$\varinjlim_{\mathcal{U}} \check{H}^1(X, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{F}) \cong H^1(X, \mathcal{F})$$

Proposition 4.4.11

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space. Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Pic}(X) \cong H^1(X, \mathcal{O}_X^*)$$

4.5 Hypercohomology

Definition 4.5.1 (Hypercohomology of a Space)

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F}^\bullet$ be a cochain complex of sheaves on X . Define the hyper cohomology of X to be the right hyper-derived functor of the global section functor:

$$\mathbb{H}^n(X; \mathcal{F}^\bullet) = \mathbb{R}^n \Gamma(\mathcal{F}^\bullet)$$

Proposition 4.5.2

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F}^\bullet \in \mathbf{CCh}^+(\mathbf{Ab}(X))$ be a bounded below cochain complex. Let $\mathcal{I}^\bullet \in \mathbf{CCh}^+(\mathbf{Ab}(X))$ be a bounded below cochain complex such that the following are true.

- I^n is injective for all n .

- There is a quasi-isomorphism $F^\bullet \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^\bullet$.

Then we have

$$\mathbb{H}^n(X; \mathcal{F}^\bullet) = H^i(\Gamma(X, \mathcal{I}^\bullet))$$

Proposition 4.5.3

Let X be a space. Let $\mathcal{F}^\bullet \in \mathbf{CCh}^+(\mathbf{Ab}(X))$ be a cochain complex of sheaves on X . Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$\mathbb{H}^n(X; \mathcal{F}^\bullet) \cong H^n(\Gamma(X, \mathrm{Tot}^\Pi(\mathrm{Gd}^\bullet, \mathcal{F}^\bullet)))$$

4.6 Relation to Singular Cohomology

Theorem 4.6.1 ((Y. Sella 2016))

Let X be a locally contractible space. Then there is an isomorphism

$$H_{\mathrm{sing}}^n(X; \mathbb{Z}) \cong H_{\mathrm{sheaf}}^n(X; \mathbb{Z})$$

4.7 Classifying Invertible Sheaves

Proposition 4.7.1

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a locally ringed space. Then there is a natural isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Pic}(X) \cong H^1(X, \mathcal{O}_X^*)$$

5 Sites, Sieves and Grothendieck Topologies

5.1 Sites on a Category

We now want to generalize the notion of sheaves to general categories, not just spaces. However, there is no notion of open sets in an arbitrary category. Grothendieck realized that the essence of sheaves comes from the data of the open covers $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ for each open set U in a space X .

Definition 5.1.1 (Covers) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. Let $U \in \mathcal{C}$ be an object. A cover of U is a collection of morphisms

$$\{U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\}$$

Definition 5.1.2 (Coverages (nLab)) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A coverage $\text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$ of $\mathcal{C}$ consists a collection of covers for each $U \in \mathcal{C}$, such that the following are true.

- If $\{f_i : U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\}$ is a cover of U and $g : V \rightarrow U$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}$, then there exists a cover $\{h_j : V_j \rightarrow V\}$ of V such that every $g \circ h_j : V_j \rightarrow U$ factors through the cover of U . Or in other words, for each $h_j : V_j \rightarrow V$, there exists U_i and $f_i : U_i \rightarrow U$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V_j & \xrightarrow{k} & U_i \\ h_j \downarrow & & \downarrow f_i \\ V & \xrightarrow{g} & U \end{array}$$

Definition 5.1.3 (Coverages (Stacks)) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a category. A coverage $\text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$ of $\mathcal{C}$ consists a collection of covers for each $U \in \mathcal{C}$, such that the following are true.

- If $V \rightarrow U$ is an isomorphism then $\{V \rightarrow U\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$
- If $\{U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$ and $\{V_{i,j} \rightarrow U_i \mid j \in J_i\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$ for each $i \in I$, then $\{V_{i,j} \rightarrow U \mid i, j \in I\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$
- If $\{f_i : U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$ and $g : V \rightarrow U$ is a morphism, then the pullback

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U_i \times_U V & \xrightarrow{\text{proj.}} & U_i \\ \text{proj.} \downarrow & & \downarrow g \\ V & \xrightarrow{f_i} & U \end{array}$$

exists for all $i \in I$ and $\{U_i \times_U V \rightarrow U\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$.

Definition 5.1.4 (Sites (nLab)) A site is a category $\mathcal{C}$ together with a coverage $\text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$.

Definition 5.1.5 (Continuous Functors) Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$ be two sites. Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a functor. We say that F is continuous if the following are true.

- F preserves fiber products
- F sends covers to covers

6 Sheaf Cohomology of Sites

6.1 Sheaves on Sites

Definition 6.1.1 (Sheaves on Sites) Let $(\mathcal{C}, \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C}))$ be a site. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be a presheaf of sets on $\mathcal{C}$. We say that $\mathcal{F}$ is a sheaf on $\mathcal{C}$ if for all $\{f_i : U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\} \in \text{Cov}(\mathcal{C})$, the following diagram

$$\mathcal{F}(U) \xrightarrow{p} \prod_{i \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i) \xrightleftharpoons[r]{q} \prod_{i,j \in I} \mathcal{F}(U_i \times_U U_j)$$

is an equalizer diagram, where p is the product of the maps $\mathcal{F}(f_i)$, q is the product of the maps $\mathcal{F}(\text{proj}_i : U_i \times_U U_j \rightarrow U_i)$ and r is the product of the maps $\mathcal{F}(\text{proj}_j : U_i \times_U U_j \rightarrow U_j)$.

Definition 6.1.2 (Abelian Sheaves) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a site. Define the category of abelian sheaves

$$\mathbf{Ab}(\mathcal{C})$$

over $\mathcal{C}$ to consist of the following data.

- The objects are the abelian sheaves on $\mathcal{C}$
- The morphisms are the natural transformations of functors
- Composition is given by the composition of natural transformations

Theorem 6.1.3 Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a site. Then $\mathbf{Ab}(\mathcal{C})$ has enough injectives.

TBA: category of abelian sheaves on $\mathcal{C}$ has enough injectives

TBA: A bunch of adjunctions analogous to that of sheaves.

6.2 Sheaf Cohomology of Sites

Definition 6.2.1 (Global Sections Functor) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a site. Define the global section functor

$$\Gamma(-, \mathcal{C}) : \mathbf{Ab}(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$$

by the following data.

- A sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on $\mathcal{C}$ is sent to $\Gamma(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{C}) = \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{C})$.
- For a morphism of sheaves $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$, the global section functor sends it to the group homomorphism $\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(\mathcal{C})$

Proposition 6.2.2 Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a site. Then the global section functor $\Gamma(-, \mathcal{C}) : \mathbf{Ab}(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ is left exact.

Definition 6.2.3 (Sheaf Cohomology of Sites) Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a site. Define the sheaf cohomology functor of $\mathcal{C}$ to be

$$H^k(\mathcal{C}, -) = R^k \Gamma : \mathbf{Ab}(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$$

the right derived functors of $\Gamma(-, \mathcal{C})$.

7 Etale Cohomology

To be removed:

Definition 7.0.1 ((Small) Etale Sites) Let X be a scheme. The etale site X_{et} over X consists of the following data.

- The underlying category is the full subcategory Sch/X of schemes over X consisting of etale morphisms $U \rightarrow X$
- The coverage consists of the surjective families of etale morphisms $\{U_i \rightarrow U \mid i \in I\}$.

Finite etale site, the flat site, the big etale site

Definition 7.0.2 (Etale Cohomology) Let X be a scheme. Define the etale cohomology of X to be the sheaf cohomology of the category X_{et} . Explicitly, this means that

$$H_{\text{et}}^k(X, -) = H^k(X_{\text{et}}, -) : \mathbf{Ab}(X_{\text{et}}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$$